



A COMMUNITY OF CHOICE

Planning and Development Department

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MEMO

To: Honorable Mayor Patrick Collins and Members of the City Council
From: Charles Bloom, AICP, Planning and Development Director
Subject: Submission of 2023 Urban Renewal Authority Annual Report
Date: May 13, 2024

Background:

The attached report provides a summary of the Urban Renewal Authority's activities over the prior calendar year. The annual report details assets, liabilities, income, and operating expenses for 2023 and is required by Wyo. Stat. § 15-9-136 and Cheyenne Municipal Code § 2.80.050.

This item will not be referred to committee.

Attachments:

1. 2023 Urban Renewal Authority Annual Report



Urban Renewal Authority

2023 Annual Report





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Urban Renewal Authority

2023 Annual Report

Purpose

The purpose of this report is to provide a summary of the Urban Renewal Authority's activities over the prior calendar year. The annual report details assets, liabilities, income, and operating expenses for 2023.

The purpose of this report is to comply with Wyo. Stat. § 15-9-136 and Cheyenne Municipal Code § 2.80.050, Annual Reports.

Background

Urban renewal is a state-enabled economic development tool used to revitalize deteriorating or underdeveloped areas. Redevelopment of urban areas is often more expensive than new development, so public action through an Urban Renewal Authority can be used to encourage private investment in the area. The Wyoming Urban Renewal Code enables municipalities to set up Urban Renewal Authorities which have the ability to designate Urban Renewal Projects. These projects can use a variety of tools for redevelopment, including tax increment financing (TIF).

The Urban Renewal Authority (URA) is comprised of a board of five members knowledgeable in community planning, urban renewal, and business management. The URA reviews Urban Renewal Plans and Projects for specific areas and makes recommendations regarding the use of Tax Increment Financing (TIF). The Urban Renewal Plans and Projects and TIF-related development agreements require approval by the Governing Body.

The URA was formed on June 28, 2021, with the passage of Ordinance No. 4381. On June 28, 2021, the Governing Body adopted Resolution No. 6156 determining that blighted areas in the community allowing the URA to execute powers under the State of Wyoming Urban Renewal Code to authorize rehabilitation and redevelopment of these defined areas as necessary for the public safety, health, morals, and welfare for the residents of the City of Cheyenne.

Summary of Activities

Plan and Projects

Active plans and projects include the:

- **Hitching Post Plan and Project**
Approved August 23, 2021
- **Hynds and Hole Plan and Project**
Approved June 13, 2022
- **15th Street Plan and Project**
Approved June 13, 2022
- **West Downtown Plan and Project**
Approved September 11, 2023

The West Downtown Plan and Project was approved during calendar year of 2023. This plan and project encompasses six blocks in the downtown.

Public Outreach

Creation of Urban Renewal Authority Website,
www.CheyenneCity.org/URA

The Urban Renewal Authority had a joint City Council work session with the Downtown Development Authority on July 7th, 2023 to discuss the programs and answer any City Council questions.

Assets

The URA obtained no assets obtained in calendar year 2023 other than tax increment revenue identified in the "Income / Balances" section of this report.

Liabilities

Through the Governing Body of the City of Cheyenne, the URA entered into a TIF development agreement pledging up to \$460,000.00 of tax increment revenue collected for overages with the initial development agreement with Swagger Construction, LLC's demolition and remediation of the Hitching Post. In 2021 the URA entered into a TIF development agreement pledging up to \$1.2 million of tax increment revenue collected for remediation of environmental hazards associated with Swagger Construction, LLC's demolition and remediation of the Hitching Post. The development agreements limit reimbursement to collected tax increment funds or the 25-year time period of the Hitching Post Urban Renewal Plan and Project and extends no financial commitment to the City or URA.



Two active pledges exist for TIF projects regarding payments to the Hitching Post Plan and Project for environmental remediation and associated overages.

Income / Balances

Fiduciary account balances for the three Plan and Project areas (Increment plus interest) for active Plans and Projects are:

1. Hitching Post: \$4,407.09
2. 15th Street: \$18,300.87
3. Hynds and the Hole: \$1,195.12
4. West Downtown Plan and Project: \$0.00

Disbursement of the of the 2023 tax increment is expected in May of 2024 contingent on property tax payment by landowners within the Plan and Project area.

Operating Expenses

The URA is acting under the umbrella of the City in the Planning and Development Department. The City is absorbing all costs associated with the URA at this time.

Financial Statement

Revenue: \$0

Expenses: \$0

Savings/Checking accounts: Not established